

way you would already have an idea of what you need to do when you get there, which would also save you a lot of time.

Another important thing is observation. A good photographer is also a good observer and you should constantly be on the look out for interesting things in your surroundings. Sometimes, even the most mundane things can look good when shot properly. Get into the habit of seeing things the way they would look after they were photographed and soon enough you'll start seeing photo opportunities everywhere. Don't just look at things but also think in your mind's eye as to how you can photograph it and if it would look good. If you think it would, take out your camera and give it a shot. Avoid shooting anything and everything. Keep the signal to noise ratio low. Don't be the person who takes pictures of everything. When shooting, shoot with the final result in mind, not just with what you're looking at. Shoot photos you'd want to see, and you'd want people to see.

## Editing

Most people don't realize this but editing is as big a part of photography as the actual shooting of images. Most of the great photos you see online are edited and enhanced to look better than what they actually were. A good editing job can salvage a poor image and make it look decent and can turn a great picture into something exceptional.

As for the first part, sometimes you take a shot that is not properly composed. Fortunately, you can fix some of the follies in post processing. The crop tool is very important and helps you keep just the part of the image you want while leaving the rest out. If you misjudged your composition you can crop the photo in such a way so that it appears much better than the original. You can edit it such that the image complies with the rule of thirds or the golden ratio even if the original image failed to. Or you could use the rotation tool to level the horizon in the image.

But of course, editing goes beyond just cropping and rotating. Among the many things you can do in post processing, is adjusting the exposure, contrast, white balance and saturation. With exposure, you can increase or decrease the amount of light in the image. You can either use the simple exposure tool for this or if you know your way around apps like Photoshop better, then something like the Curves tool. You can also use the shadows and highlights tool to increase the amount of details in the shadows and try to reduce blown highlights respectively.